Identifying the Presence of Research-Based Predictors in Transition Experiences of Students with Intellectual Disability using NLTS 2012

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Session objectives

- Explain how to access information on research-based predictors for transition
- Explain the extent to which youth with ID/A are accessing research-based predictors for transition according to findings from recent data
- State three implications for improving transition practice based on findings

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Moving Transition Forward: Exploration of College-based and Conventional Transition Practices for Students with Intellectual Disability and Autism (ID/A) project will examine the composition and impact of existing transition practices via secondary analysis of two national datasets. This three-phase study will define, explore, and compare critical aspects of two transition approaches:

1. a college-based transition experience provided via partnership between a local education agencies (LEAs) and institutions of higher education (IHEs), and
2. a conventional transition experience offered by a LEA in a high school or community setting.

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Moving Transition Forward Studies

Conventional Transition Services (NLTS 2012)

Research Based Predictors

Employment Preparation

College Preparation

College-Based Transition Services (TPSID)

Research Based Predictors

Employment Preparation

College Preparation

NTACT's In-School Predictors of Post-School Success

https://transitionta.org/postschool

NTACT
National Technical Assistance Center on Transition

RESOURCES EFFECTIVE PRACTICES EVENTS ASD RESOURCES

Post-school Success

The purpose of the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (2004) is to ensure that all children with disabilities have available to them a free appropriate public education that emphasizes special education and related services designed to meet their unique needs and prepare them for further education, employment, and independent living. As the OSEP and RSA funded technical assistance and dissemination center focused on improving the postsecondary outcomes of students with disabilities, one of NTAC T's primary charges is to assist state and local agencies' capacity to increase student access to, participation in, and success in (a) rigorous academic coursework and (b) career-related curricula designed to prepare students for postsecondary education and careers.

GETTING STARTED

Predictor Descriptions
LAST UPDATED: 09/18/2020

download

Effective Predictors Matrix.

Research-Based Predictors
LAST UPDATED: 12/19/2018

download

KEY RESOURCES

The Guide for Using the PISA
LAST UPDATED: 09/18/2020

download

This document provides information about the process a school-level team will use to complete the Predictor Implementation School/ District Self-Assessment (PISA).

Predictors of post-school success

Career awareness	Paid employment	Social skills
Career technical education	Parent expectations	Student support
Community experiences	Parent involvement	Technology skills
Exit exam/diploma status	Program of study	Transition program
Goal setting	Psychological empowerment	Travel skills
Inclusion in general ed	Self-care/ind living skills	Work study
Interagency collaboration	Self-determination	Youth autonomy
Occupational courses	Self-realization	

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Research questions

1. To what extent are in-school predictors of post-school success reflected in transition experiences of youth with ID?
2. Are there differences in extent to which youth with ID experience in-school predictors compared with youth with autism or other disabilities?

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Study Methods and Results

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NLTS 2012

- Nationally representative sample of about 13,000 youth ages 13-21 during 2011-12 school year
- Phase 1: Surveys completed with parents and students

Phase 2 (in progress): high school and post-high school administrative records data to collect information in three broad areas important to understanding outcomes for youth with disabilities: (1) High school course-taking and completion (2) post-secondary education and training, and (3) employment and earnings after high school.

Our sample

- 1,400 youth with ID (includes youth with autism and ID)
- 1,000 youth with autism (no ID)
- 8,060 youth with other disabilities who have IEPs

Variable selection process

- Reviewed predictor definitions and original research
- Reviewed NLTS 2012 data dictionary and published reports
- Identified variables in NLTS 2012 that most closely matched definitions and prior research
  - Matched 15 predictors
    - One predictor (parent involvement) had 3 variables that matched
  - No match for 8 predictors

Analysis

- All variables coded as binary (present/not present)
- Data analyzed using SPSS Complex Samples
- Weights applied to generate national estimates
- Calculated:
  - 95% confidence interval
  - Cohen's effect size h of differences
  - Chi-square test of statistical significance

High prevalence (ID >= 66.7%)

Predictor	ID (95% CI)
Transition program	99% (98 to 100)
Psychological empowerment	96% (94 to 98)
Self-realization	96% (94 to 98)
Parent involvement (talked about school)	92% (91 to 94)
Parent involvement (attended IEP meeting)	86% (83 to 89)
Social skills	85% (83 to 87)

Considerations

Existence of Transition Program and Parent involvement are both mandated under IDEA

Social skills variables may not reflect use of skill in transition contexts

Level of prevalence ≠ greater impact on outcomes

Medium prevalence (66.7% > ID > 33.3%)

Predictor	**ID (95% CI)**
Travel skills	60% (56 to 63)
Career awareness	58% (53 to 63)
Interagency collaboration	50% (45 to 55)
Youth autonomy/decision making	43% (38 to 47)

Considerations

- Impact of moderately prevalent travel skills on employment/postsecondary education access
- Need to consider age of sample
- Lack of high prevalence of career awareness problematic for employment pathways
- Interagency collaboration can be a + or a -
- Youth autonomy hard to interpret without outcome data

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Lower prevalence (ID <= 33.3%)

Predictor	ID (95% CI)
Parent involvement (helped with homework)	33% (30 to 36)
Parent expectations	33% (29 to 37)
Paid employment/work experience	32% (29 to 36)
Self-determination/self-advocacy	32% (28 to 36)
Self-care/ independent living skills	27% (23 to 30)
Occupational courses	25% (22 to 28)
Work-study	23% (20 to 26)

Considerations

6 of the 7 low prevalence variables corresponded with predictors of employment outcomes

Need to review age of participants

Systemic prevalence of low parent expectations

Youth with ID vs. other disabilities

- Differed on all predictors other than
  - Transition Program
  - Parent Involvement (attended IEP meeting)

Youth with ID vs. other disabilities

- Large effect size:
  - Parent expectations: Youth with ID = 33% vs. youth with other disabilities = 78%
- Medium effect size:
  - Travel skills: Youth with ID = 60% vs. youth with other disabilities = 90%
  - Self-care/independent living skills: Youth with ID = 33% vs. youth with other disabilities = 78%
- Small effect size: All others

Youth with ID vs. other disabilities

Most comparisons were youth with ID < youth with other disabilities, but two exceptions:

- Interagency collaboration
- Work study

Considerations

What are parents of students with other disabilities hearing that parents of students with ID are not?

How much of these differences are opportunity based?

In the long run does interagency collaboration improve outcomes?

Youth with ID vs. Autism

- Few differences overall
- Parent involvement (attended IEP meeting) higher for youth with autism
  - Youth with ID = 86% vs. Youth with autism = 93%, Cohen's h = small, $p<.001$
- Five other predictors were statistically significant but effect size was negligible

Considerations

If the prevalence of predictors are similar does this translate to similar outcomes?

Implications for Transition Practice

Big Picture

Mandated predictors are evident but those with direct impact on post-school outcomes are less prevalent

Difficult to determine how important highly prevalent predictors are in terms of outcomes

Imperfect matching of predictors to study variables

Same message-different dataset

We need more intentional and consistent practices

- Career development
- Work study
- Travel skills
- Self-determination
- Parent expectations

Resources

NTACT Resources on predictors

Go to: https://www.transitionta.org

Click on Resources

Resources & Guidance

NTACT provides resources and guidance in the following areas:

Transition Planning

Guidance for student-centered transition planning, education, and services. Resources include online modules, toolkits, checklists, practice descriptions, lesson plans, work-based learning experience guidance, and resources for students. Video Overview

VIEW RESOURCES

Graduation

Effective practices for keeping students with disabilities engaged in school, on-track for graduation, and for re-engagement. Resources include practice guides, research syntheses, and data collection tools.

VIEW RESOURCES

Post-school Success

Practices, programs, and skills for success in college, careers, and community. Resources include program assessments, guidance for collaboration, and practice descriptions.

VIEW RESOURCES

Data Analysis & Use

Collecting quality data for meaningful program improvement focused on secondary education and services for students with disabilities. Resources focus on both federal data collection and reporting requirements and school, program, and community data use.

VIEW RESOURCES

Lesson plans
Toolkits
Presentations and webinars

Annotated bibliographies
Practice and predictor descriptions
Quick guides

Paid Work Correlated with Improved Education, Employment, and Independent Living Outcomes

What is the level of evidence?

This predictor of post-school success has been labeled by NTACT at a Research Based level of evidence to improve education and employment outcomes, based on six *a priori* correlational studies and a Promising level of evidence to improve independent living outcomes, based on one *a priori* correlational study. *More information on NTACT's process for identifying effective practices is available here: NTACT's Effective Practices.*

What is the predictor?

Work experience is any activity that places the student in an authentic workplace, and could include: work sampling, job shadowing, internships, apprenticeships, and paid employment. Paid employment can include existing standard jobs in a company or organization or customized work assignments negotiated with the employer, but these activities always feature competitive pay (e.g., minimum wage) paid directly to the student by the employer.

What are the essential characteristics?

1. Provide opportunities to participate in job shadowing, work-study, apprenticeships, or internships.

***Consider work study, apprenticeships, and internship environments that are culturally sensitive to students from different cultural backgrounds.*

2. Provide instruction in soft skills (e.g., problem solving, communicating with authority figures, responding to feedback, promptness) and occupational specific skills (e.g., clerical, machine operation).
3. Provide transportation training, including the use of public transportation and job-site and community safety.
4. Conduct job performance evaluations by student, school staff, and employer.
5. Provide instruction in obtaining (e.g., resume development) and maintaining a job.
6. Develop a process for community-based employment options in integrated settings with a majority of co-workers without disabilities.
7. Conduct situational vocational assessments to determine appropriate job matches.
8. Develop a process to enable students to earn high school credit for paid employment work experience.

9. Link eligible students to appropriate adult services (e.g. Vocational Rehabilitation, Developmental Disabilities Services) services prior to exiting school that will support student in work or further education.
10. Involve appropriate adult services (e.g., Vocational Rehabilitation or job coach when needed) in the provision of community-based work experiences.
11. Use age-appropriate assessments to ensure jobs are based on students' strengths, preferences, interest, and needs.
12. Ensure employment training placements offer opportunities for (1) working 30+ hours/week, (2) making minimum wage or higher, with benefits, and (3) utilizing individualized supports and reasonable accommodations.

Where is the best place to find out how to do this practice?

The Division on Career Development and Transition of the Council for Exceptional Children developed a Fast Fact on Paid Work Experiences available here: https://higherlogicdownload.s3.amazonaws.com/SPED/34aee1c1-7ded-4d59-af82-da4af08d5fc4/UploadedImages/DCDT_Paid_Work_Delphi_Final.pdf.

Additionally, the National Collaborative on Workforce and Disability for Youth developed a Practice Brief on work experiences for youth: http://www.ncwd-youth.info/innovative-strategies/practice-briefs/engaging-youth-in-work-experiences.

References used to establish this evidence base:

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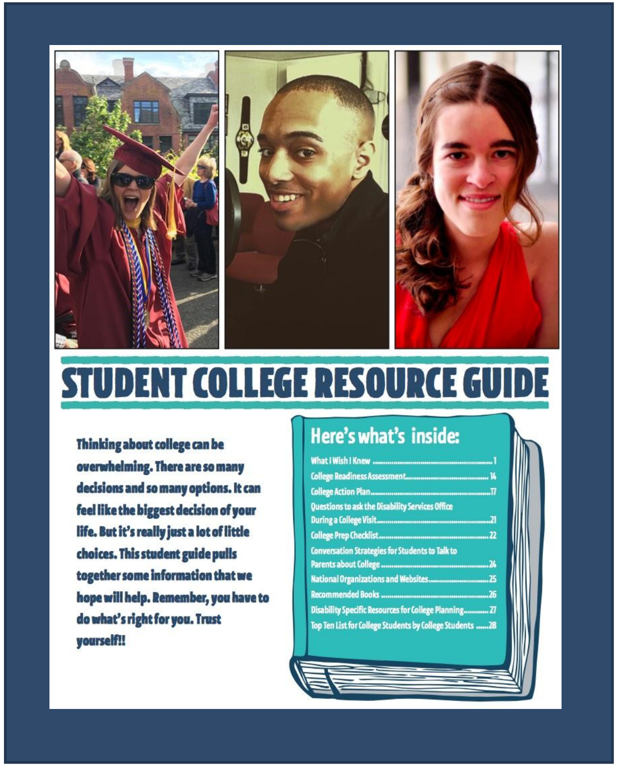
Carter, E. W., Austin, D., & Trainor, A. A. (2012). Predictors mof postschool employment outcomes for young adults with severe disabilities. *Journal of Disability Policy Studies*, *23*, 50–63.

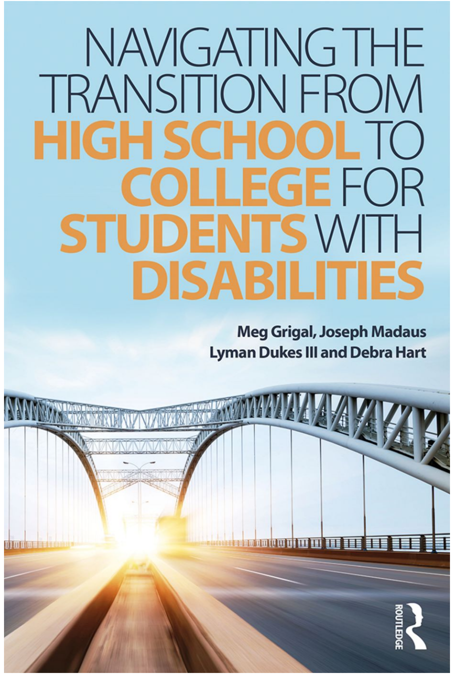
Student Resource Guide



FREE

https://thinkcollege.net/sites/default/files/files/resources/FinalStudentResourceGuide.pdf

For more information on transitioning to college for students with disabilities



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Transition to College for
Student with Disabilities

https://www.routledge.com/

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